CORESIGHT RESEARCH PROPRIETARY DATA

October 7, 2026

US Consumer Survey Insights Extra

Seasonal Shopping, 4Q26—Previewing Shoppers' Plans Across the Fourth Quarter

CORESIGHT RESEARCH



Executive Summary

US consumers are entering 4Q26 with an appetite to participate in major shopping events, but their willingness to spend is tempered by worsening perceptions of household finances and inflation. Black Friday remains the strongest demand moment, while early-season events such as Prime Big Deal Days are attracting shopper attention primarily as deal discovery opportunities. Across events, apparel and electronics are key purchase categories, omnichannel shopping is entrenched, and higher-income consumers are positioned to provide disproportionate support to holiday spending.

4Q26 Holidays

Black Friday Remains The Season's Anchor, While Early Deal Event Capture Shopper Attention

- 61.1% of consumers plan to browse or spend on Amazon's **Prime Big Deal Days**, but only 20.0% expect to purchase, suggesting that early-season events are important discovery and deal-shopping moments, with conversion dependent on compelling offers.
- 64.6% consumers expect to spend on **Black Friday;** and 84.2% of those shoppers plan to shop online (solely or partly), underscoring omnichannel's dominant role.
- Apparel and electronics remain the top categories for both events, with fashion/footwear expected to lead both in-store and online purchases. The 4Q26 holiday season is
- **Walmart** and **Amazon** are the top two retailers for Black Friday, with Amazon holding a lead of 17.4 percentage points (PPTs) over Walmart.

Halloween

- 54.4% of consumers plan to spend this year. Expected median spend: $100; net 2.0% expect to spend less than last year.

Singles' Day

- Singles' Day has meaningful awareness, with 43.6% expecting to browse or spend, but only 16.7% currently expect to purchase, making retailer participation and deal availability critical to conversion.
- One-third of shoppers expect to buy food or beverages, which remains the most popular category among potential Singles' Day shoppers. We expect that consumers' actual Singles' Day participation will depend heavily on the selection of retailers that opt in to 11.11 promotions, with the certainty of finding deals across banners lower than around traditional events such as Black Friday.

2026 Holiday Preview

- A net 4.6% of consumers expect to spend more for the holidays than last year, but it would be more of inflation-led.
- A net 6.0% of respondents who celebrate the holidays expect their financial situation to be worse this holiday season than it is now—a further drop from June 2026, when a net 3.5% of respondents expected their financial situation to be worse.
- High-income consumers ($100K+) show the strongest optimism (net 7.4% are optimistic); low-income shoppers remain cautious and are net pessimistic at 9.8%.

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Executive Summary (Continued)

What We Think (Summary)

The 2026 holiday season is likely to be characterized by cautious optimism, increased deal discovery and uneven consumer spending patterns. While consumers appear willing to participate in key shopping moments, underlying financial concerns suggest that retailers will need to work harder to unlock discretionary spending. We expect holiday growth to be driven less by broad-based consumer confidence and more by targeted promotions, value-oriented shopping behavior and higher-income households' continued willingness to spend.

Holiday 2026 spending expectations remain positive, but momentum has softened, as highlighted in our main ***Holiday 2026: US Consumer Survey and Retail Outlook*** report (published October 5, 2026). Consumers are rethinking how they shop, with their financial situation and inflationary pressure becoming the leading factors influencing holiday budgets. Higher-income shoppers are likely to continue supporting discretionary purchases, while more budget-conscious consumers are expected to rely on promotions, value-oriented channels and trade-down strategies.

- See the end of this report for the full "What We Think."



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Introduction

In our *US Consumer Survey Insights Extra* series, we provide deeper analysis of specific consumer trends, behaviors and seasonal topics identified through our weekly surveys of US consumers (published in our weekly *US Consumer Survey Insights* reports).

This report is part of our quarterly *Seasonal Shopping* series which examines consumer expectations and behaviors around key shopping occasions throughout the year. In this report, we assess holiday shopping expectations for calendar events in the fourth quarter of 2026 (4Q26, October–December):

- Amazon's Big Deal Days (October 6–7)
- Halloween (October 31)
- Singles' Day (November 11)
- Black Friday (November 27)

We also look ahead to the 2026 end-of-year holiday season. Look out for our full holiday survey report, publishing soon.

We then review 3Q26, analyzing how consumers celebrated holidays and how their behavior compared to consumers' earlier plans, covering:

- Amazon's Prime Day (June 23–26)
- The Fourth of July (July 4)
- Labor Day (September 7)

Next quarter, our *US Consumer Survey Insights Extra: Seasonal Shopping* report will look ahead to events in 1Q27.



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4Q26 Holidays

Overview

Amazon's Prime Big Deal Days

20.0% plan to **spend**

41.1% plan to browse, but are not sure whether they will spend

Black Friday

64.6% plan to **spend**

45.9% plan to shop via omnichannel

Singles' Day

16.7% plan to **spend**

26.9% plan to browse, but are not sure whether they will spend

Halloween

54.4% plan to **spend**

20.7% plan to celebrate but will not spend

Base : ~400 US respondents aged 18+, surveyed in July–September 2026
Source: Coresight Research

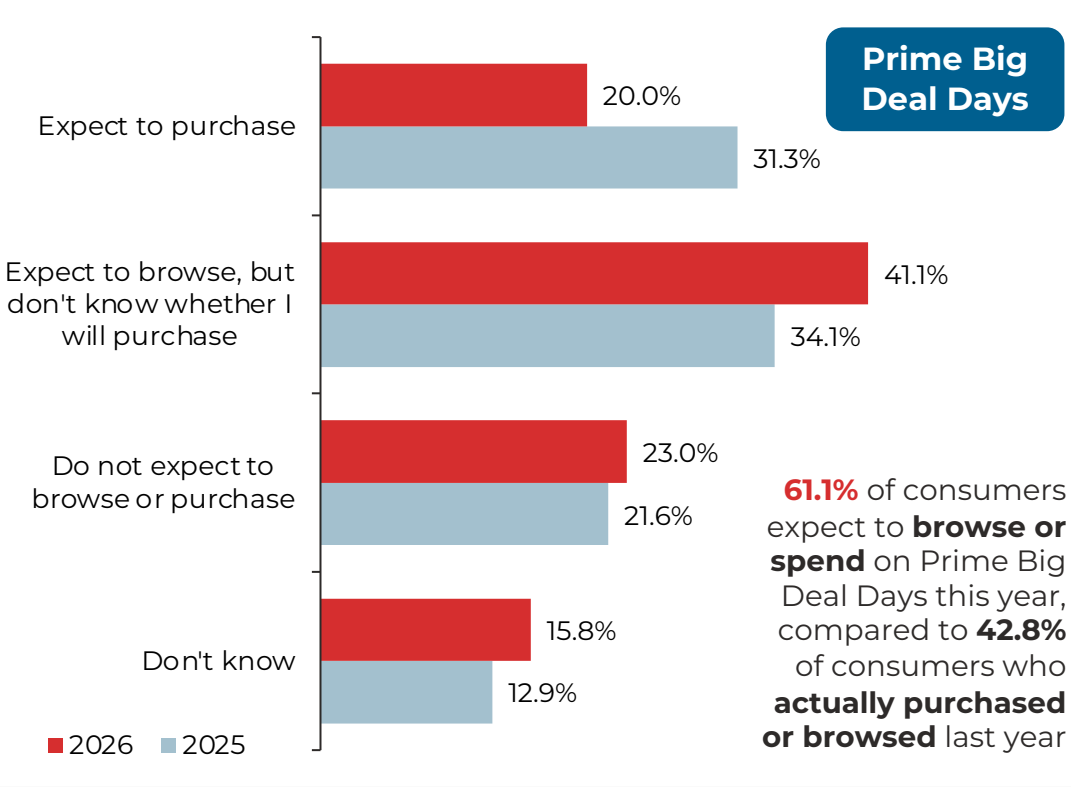
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Amazon's Prime Big Deal Days vs. Black Friday

One in five shoppers expect to spend on Amazon's Prime Big Deal Days, while seven in 10 expect to spend on Black Friday

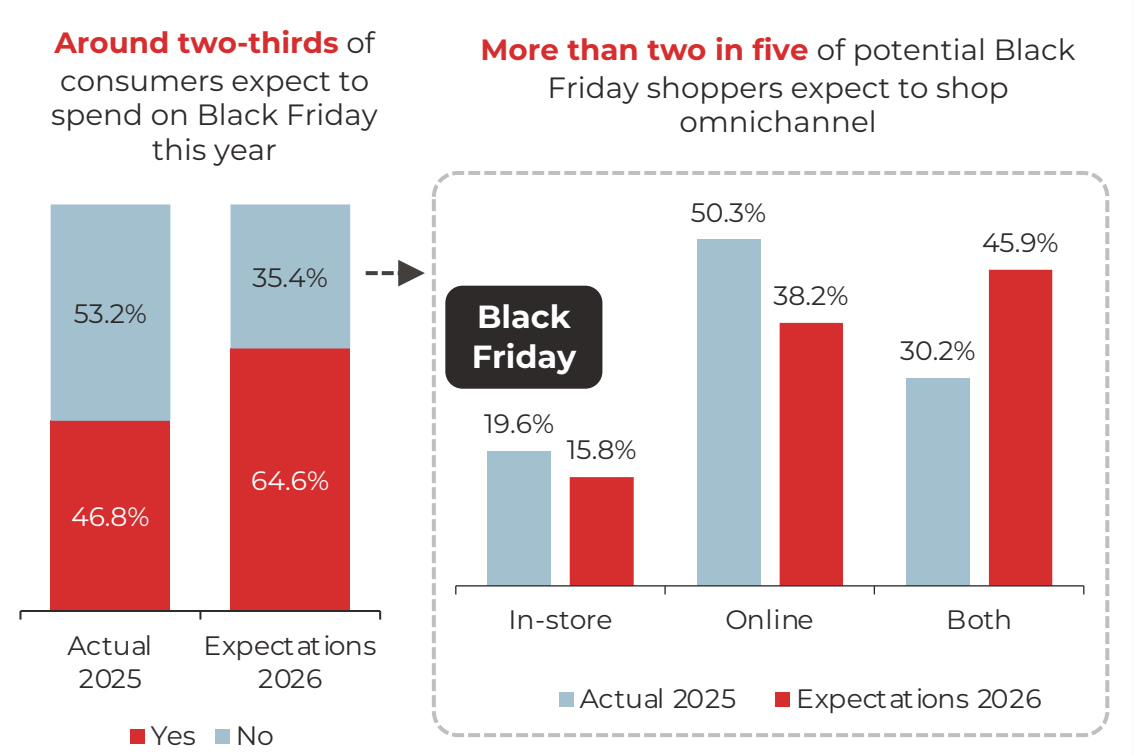
Amazon deal events continue to attract shopper attention, but conversion remains dependent on deal strength and consumer willingness to spend. Prime Big Deal Days is expected to generate meaningful engagement, with 61.1% of consumers planning to browse or spend; however, purchase intent remains cautious, with only 20.0% expecting to buy. This follows a softer Prime Day 2026, when the share of consumers who purchased on Amazon declined to 31.5% from 48.2% in 2025 (also see Figure 21), suggesting that shoppers are becoming more selective even during major promotional events.

Figure 1.
All Respondents: Whether They Expect To Spend During Prime Big Deal Days 2026 (% of Respondents)



Base: 404 US respondents aged 18+, surveyed in August 2026
Source: Coresight Research

Figure 2.
All Respondents: Whether They Expect to or Did Shop on Black Friday (Left) and Where They Expect To or Did Shop (Right; % of Respondents)

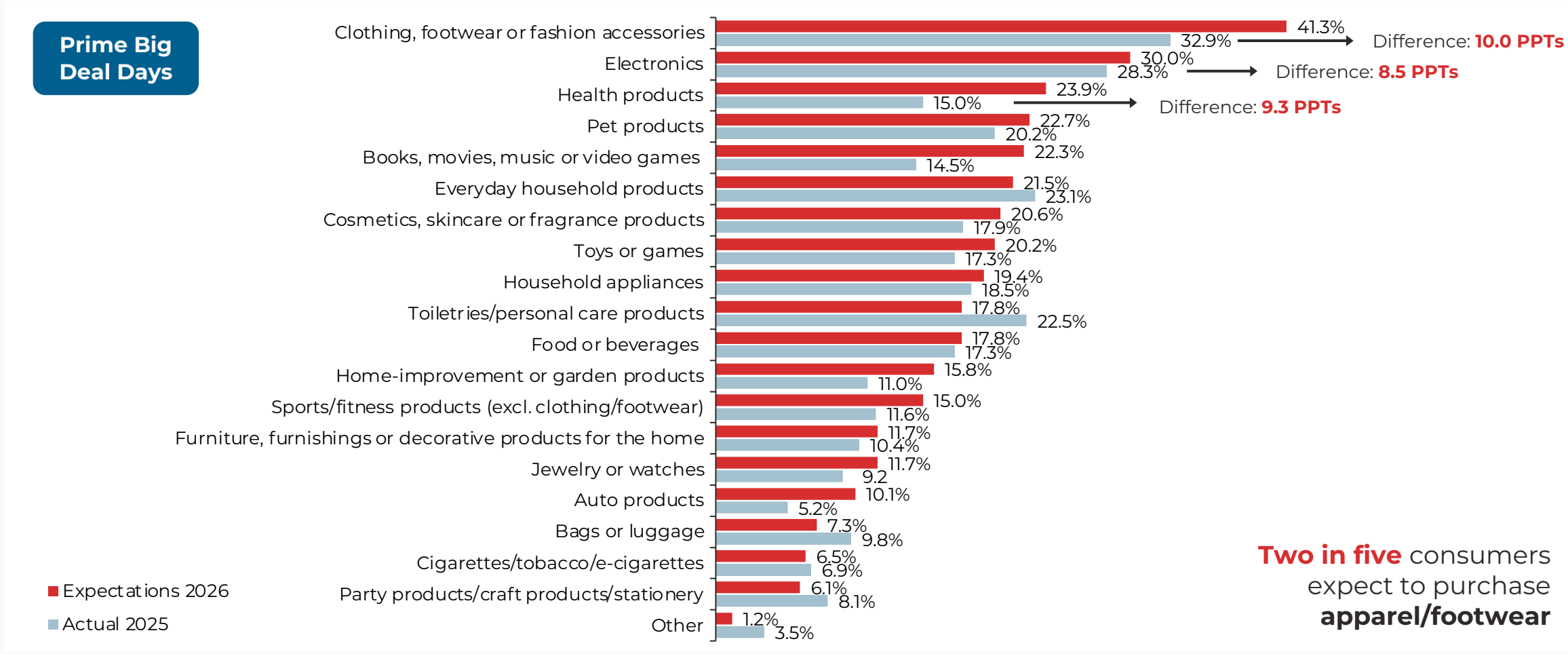


Base: Expectations 2026–401 US respondents aged 18+, surveyed in August 2026 and Actual 2025–404 surveyed in December 2025 (left chart) and Expectations 2026–259 who expect to spend on Black Friday surveyed in August 2026 and Actual 2025–189 surveyed in December 2025 (right chart)
Source: Coresight Research

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Most shoppers expect to spend on apparel and electronics on both Amazon's Prime Big Deal Days and Black Friday

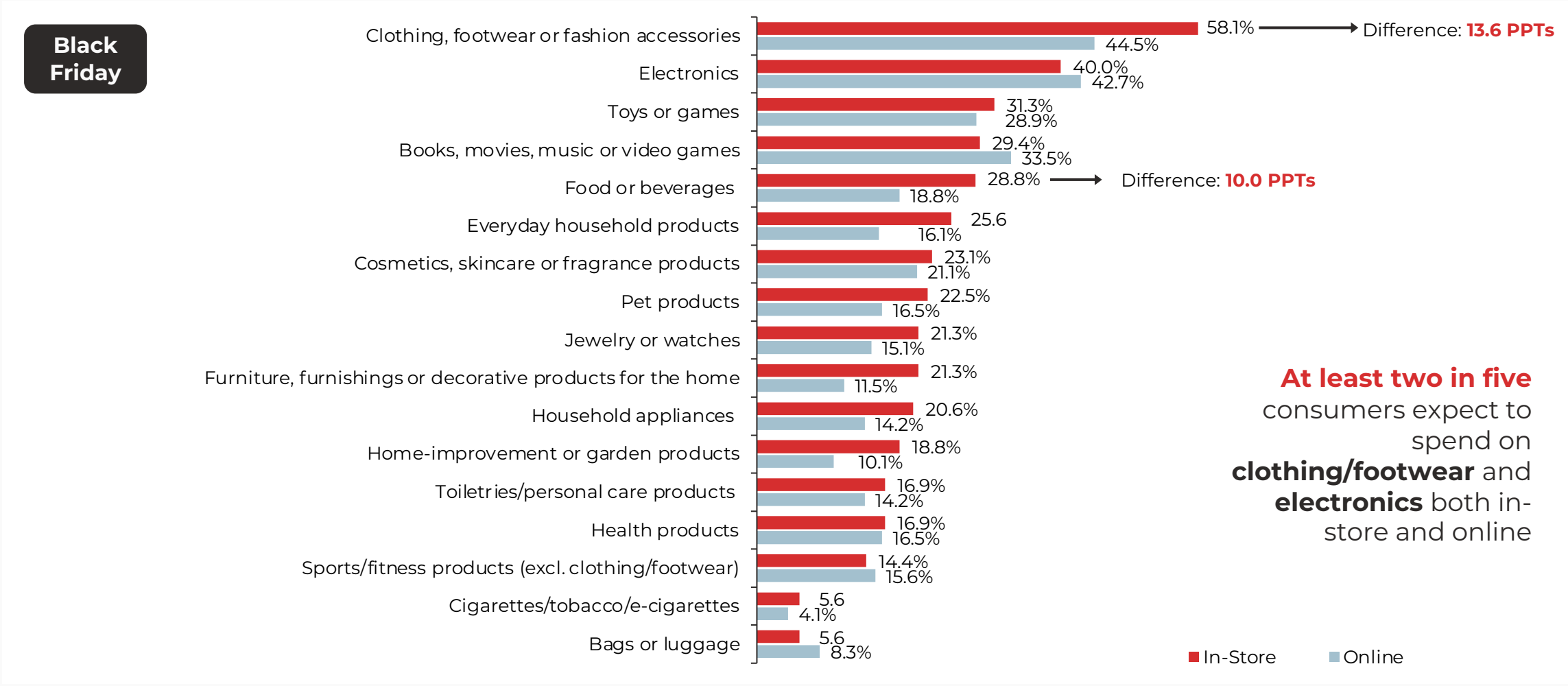
Figure 3.
Potential Prime Big Deal Days Shoppers: Product Categories They Expect To or Did Browse/Purchase (% of Respondents)



Base: Expectations 2026: 247 US respondents aged 18+ who expect to browse or purchase on Prime Big Deal Days surveyed in August 2026; Actual 2025: 173 surveyed in October 2025
Source: Coresight Research

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Figure 4.
Respondents Who Expect to Spend on Black Friday: Product Categories They Expect To Purchase In-Store/Online (% of Respondents)



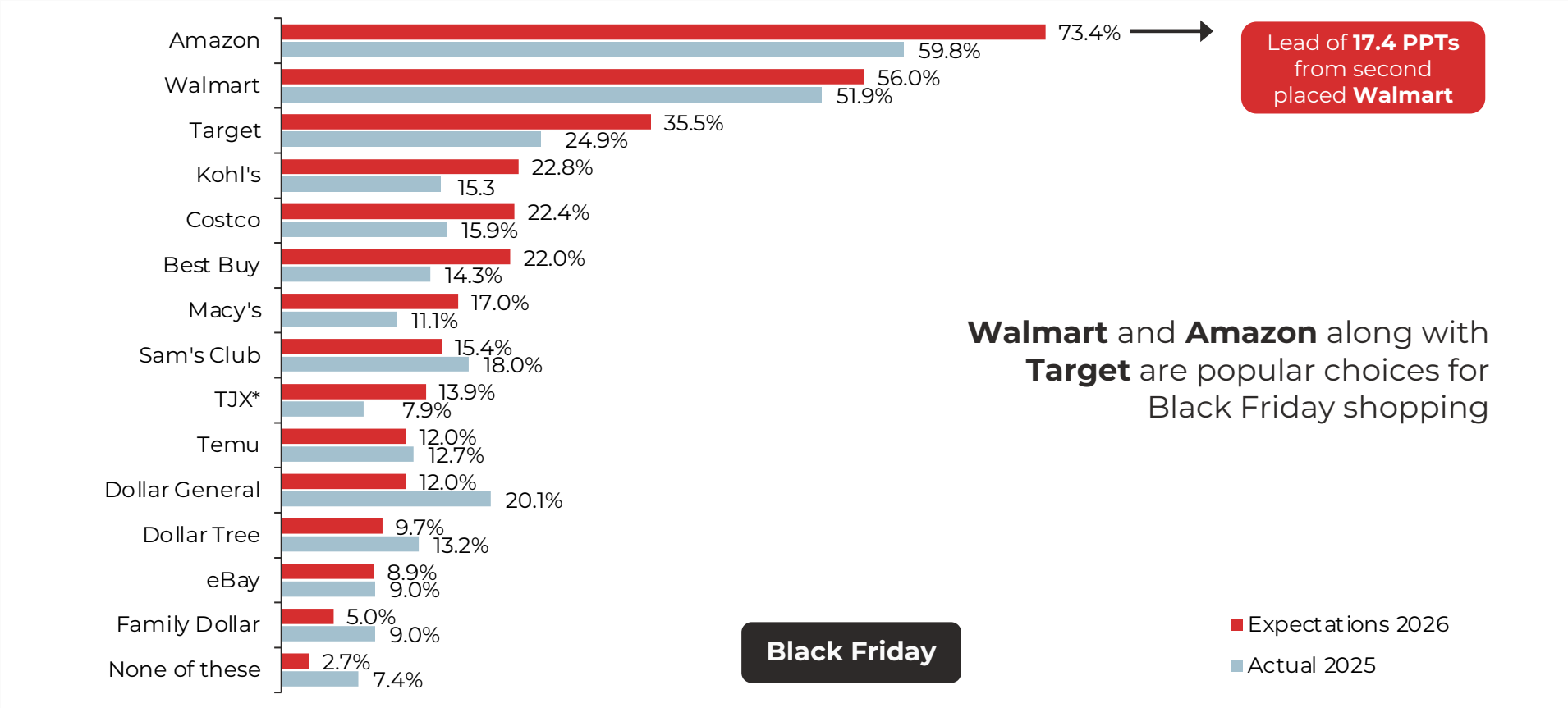
Respondents could select multiple options
Base: 259 US respondents aged 18+ who expect to spend on Black Friday, surveyed in August 2026
Source: Coresight Research

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Black Friday

At least half of Black Friday shoppers expect to shop at Walmart and Amazon

Figure 5.
Respondents Who Expect to Spend on Black Friday: Which Retailer They Expect to Shop at (% of Respondents)



Respondents could select multiple options
**TJX banners specified as HomeGoods, Homesense, Marshalls, Sierra and T.J. Maxx*
Base: Expectations 2026–259 who expect to spend on Black Friday surveyed in August 2026 and Actual 2025–189 surveyed in December 2025
Source: Coresight Research

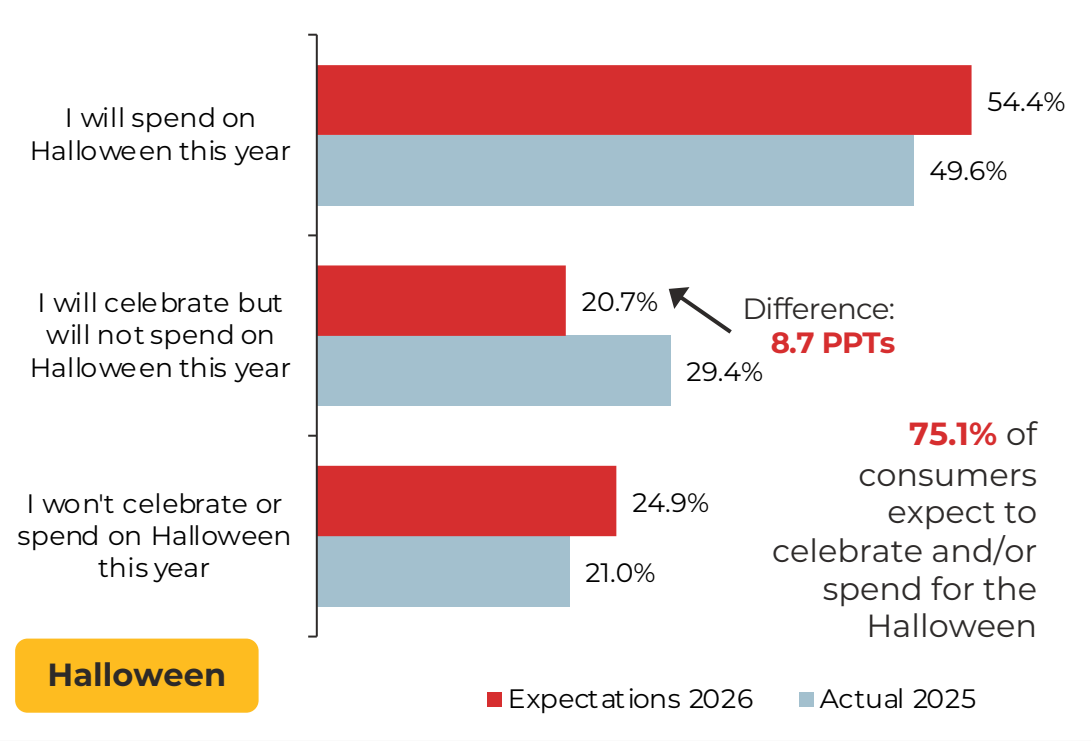
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Halloween

Fewer consumers expect to spend more this year

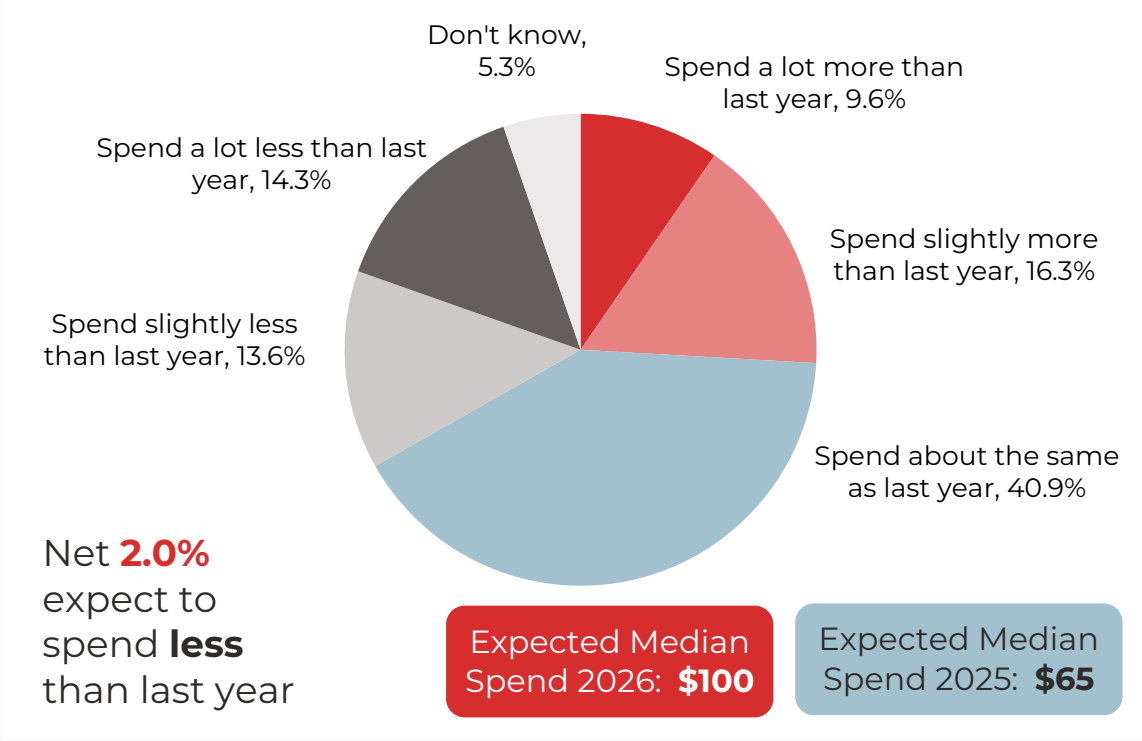
Consumers' median spending estimates and expectations to spend suggest total Halloween spending of around **$14.7 billion** this year. (this reflects spending by consumers aged 18+).

Figure 6.
All Respondents: Whether They Expect To Celebrate and/or Spend on Halloween 2025 (% of Respondents)



Base: Expectations 2026: 401 US respondents aged 18+, surveyed in September 2026; and Actual 2025: 371 surveyed in November 2025
Source: Coresight Research

Figure 7.
Respondents Who Expect To Spend on Halloween: How Much They Expect To Spend Compared to Last Year (% of Respondents)

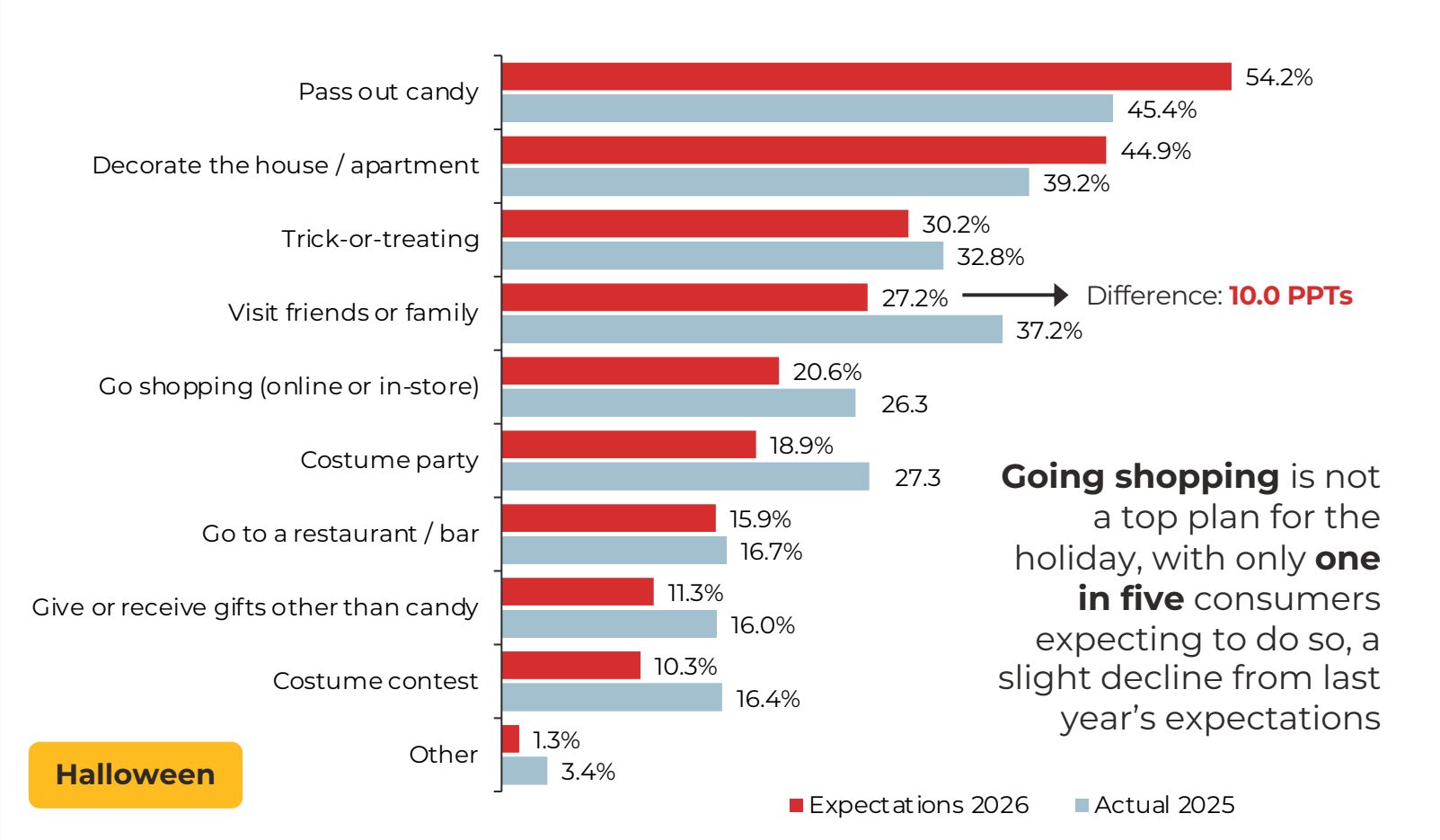


Base: Expectations 2026: 301 US respondents aged 18+ who expect to spend on Halloween, surveyed in September 2026; and Actual 2025: 293 US respondents aged 18+ who spent on Halloween, surveyed in November 2025
Source: Coresight Research

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Most consumers plan to pass out candy during Halloween

Figure 8.
Respondents Who Expect To Celebrate Halloween: How They Expect To Celebrate (% of Respondents)



Overall, consumers plan to celebrate at **lower levels** across most categories compared to actuals in 2025

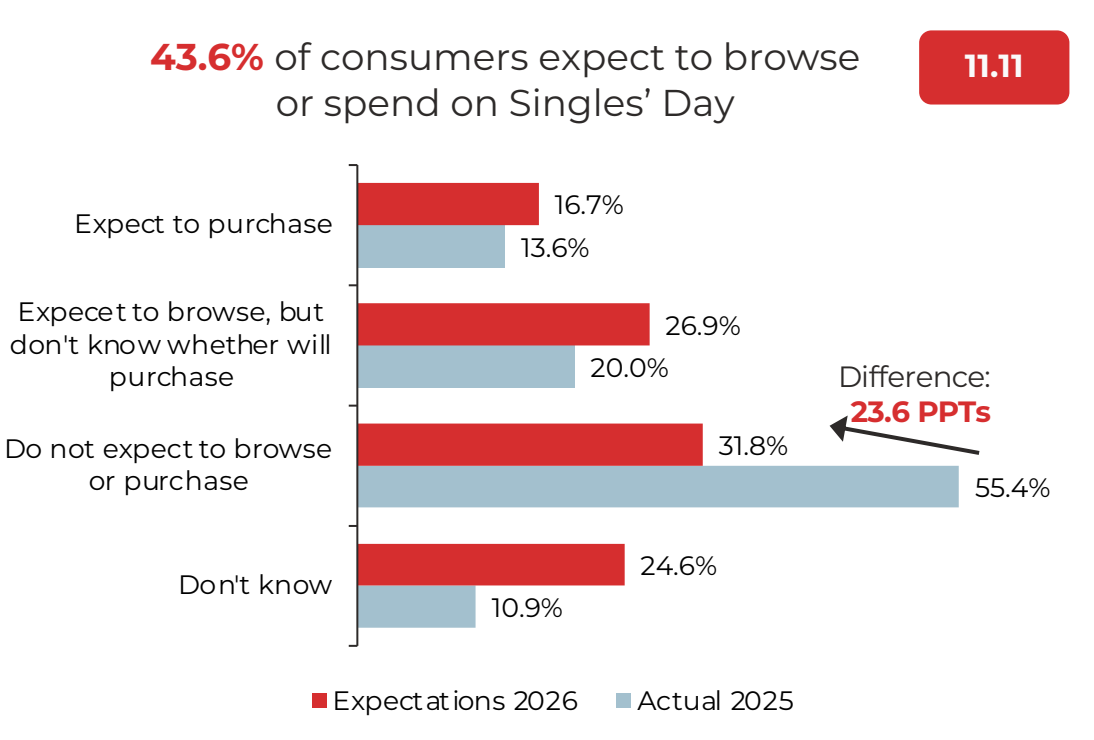
Base: Expectations 2026: 301 US respondents aged 18+ who expect to spend on Halloween, surveyed in September 2026; and Actual 2025: 293 US respondents aged 18+ who spent on Halloween, surveyed in November 2025
Source: Coresight Research

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Singles' Day/11.11

We expect that consumers' actual Singles' Day participation will depend heavily on the selection of retailers that opt in to 11.11 promotions, with the certainty of finding deals across banners lower than around traditional events such as Black Friday.

Figure 9.
All Respondents: Whether They Expect To Spend on Singles' Day 2025 (% of Respondents)



Base: 402 US respondents aged 18+, surveyed in August 2026; and 404 surveyed in November 2025
Source: Coresight Research

Food/beverages, toiletries/personal care and clothing/footwear look set to dominate 11.11

Figure 10.
Potential Singles' Day Shoppers: Product Categories They Expect To Purchase (% of Respondents)



Base: 175 US respondents aged 18+ who expect to browse or purchase on Singles' Day, surveyed in August 2026; and 136 who spent on Single's Day in 2025, surveyed in November 2025
Source: Coresight Research

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2026 Holiday Season: Preview

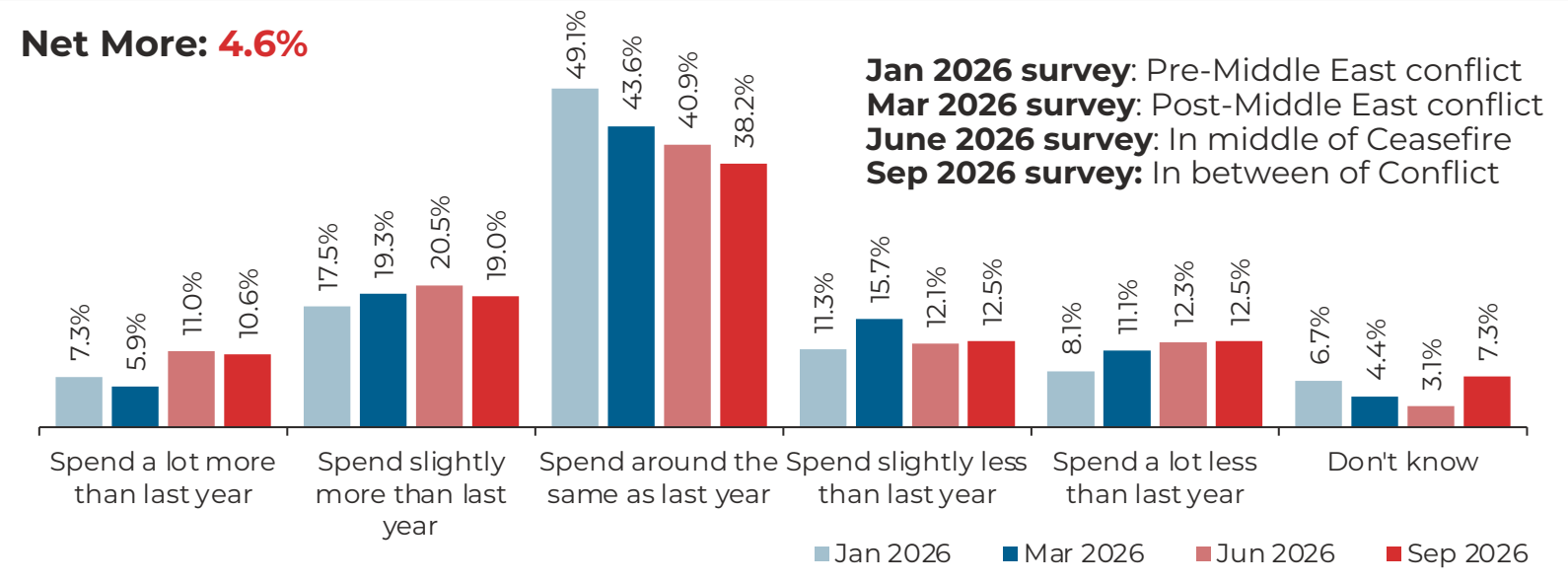
Every quarter, our *Seasonal Shopping* series asks consumers a series of questions about their expectations for the year-end holiday season.

For a comprehensive analysis of Holiday 2026 spending expectations, shopping behaviors and retail implications, please refer to our in-depth ***Holiday 2026: US Consumer Survey and Retail Outlook*** report.

The shift in consumer expectations to spend more in 2026 compared to 2025, particularly in September 2026, reflects some optimism, but less so, and for **more than three in five consumers** (not charted), the main reason to spend more is because the things will cost more this year (inflationary pressure).

Consumers expect to spend more this holiday season than they spent last year

Figure 11.
Holiday Shoppers: How They Expect Their Upcoming Holiday Spending to Compare to the Previous Year, 2026 vs. 2025 (% of Respondents)



Looking ahead to Holiday 2026, consumers are optimistic about total spending. A net **4.6%** of holiday shoppers now expect to **spend more** compared with holiday 2025, marking a **slight shift** from June 2026, when a net 7.1% of holiday shoppers* anticipated spending more than they did during holiday 2025.

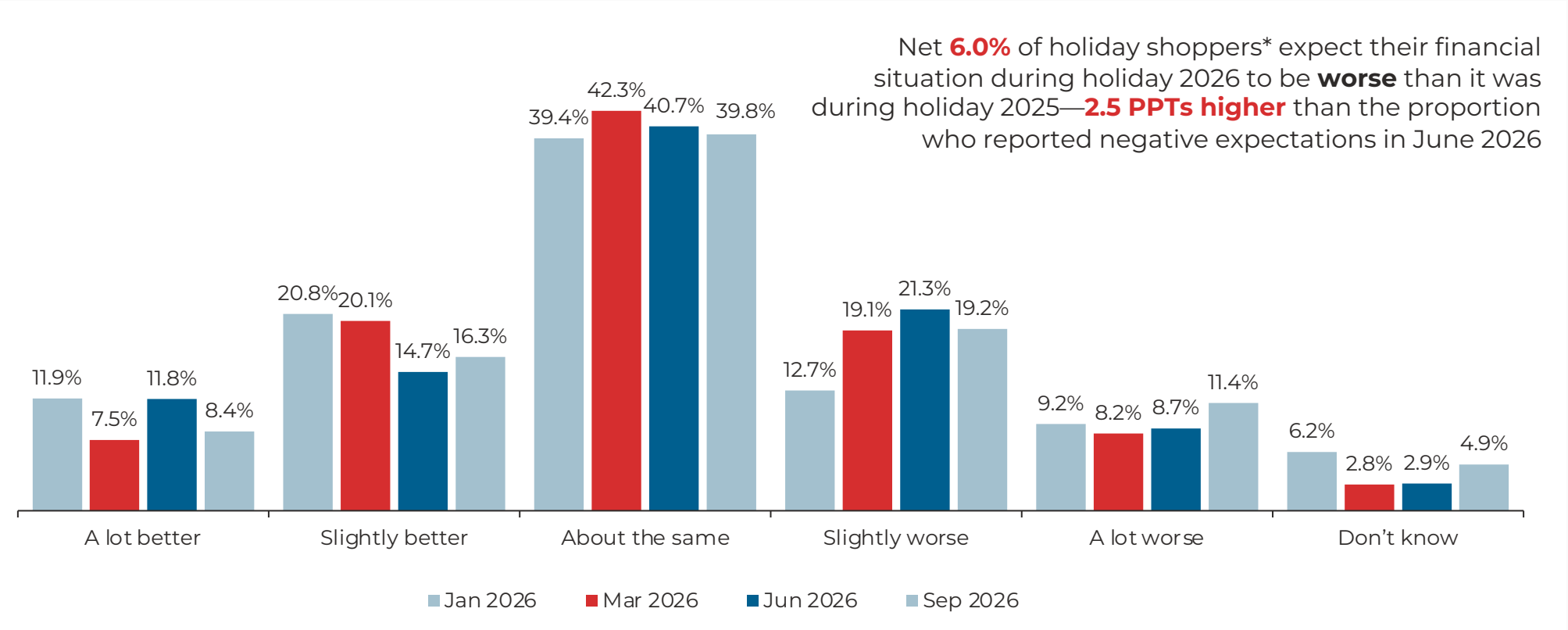
Base: US respondents aged 18+ who celebrate the holiday season—369 surveyed on September 28, 2026 (about expectations for the 2026 holiday season); 381 surveyed on June 1, 2026 (about expectations for the 2026 holiday season); 388 surveyed on March 9, 2026 (about expectations for the 2026 holiday season); and 371 surveyed on January 19, 2026 (about expectations for the 2026 holiday season)
Source: Coresight Research

**Net more = A lot and slightly more minus a lot and slightly less*
PPTs = Percentage points

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...but consumers feel pessimistic about their financial situation

Figure 12.
Holiday Shoppers: How They Expect Their Financial Situation in the Upcoming Holiday Season to Compare to the Previous Year, 2026 vs. 2025 (% of Respondents)



Base: US respondents aged 18+ who celebrate the holiday season—369 surveyed on September 28, 2026 (about expectations for the 2026 holiday season); 381 surveyed on June 1, 2026 (about expectations for the 2026 holiday season); 388 surveyed on March 9, 2026 (about expectations for the 2026 holiday season); and 371 surveyed on January 19, 2026 (about expectations for the 2026 holiday season)
Source: Coresight Research

**Net better = A lot and slightly better minus a lot and slightly worse*

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Higher-income consumers are the most optimistic, while lower-income consumers are most pessimistic

Consumers with household incomes of less than $50,000 are the most likely to expect that their financial status will be worse during the 2026 holiday season compared to during the 2025.

Higher-income consumers are most optimistic.

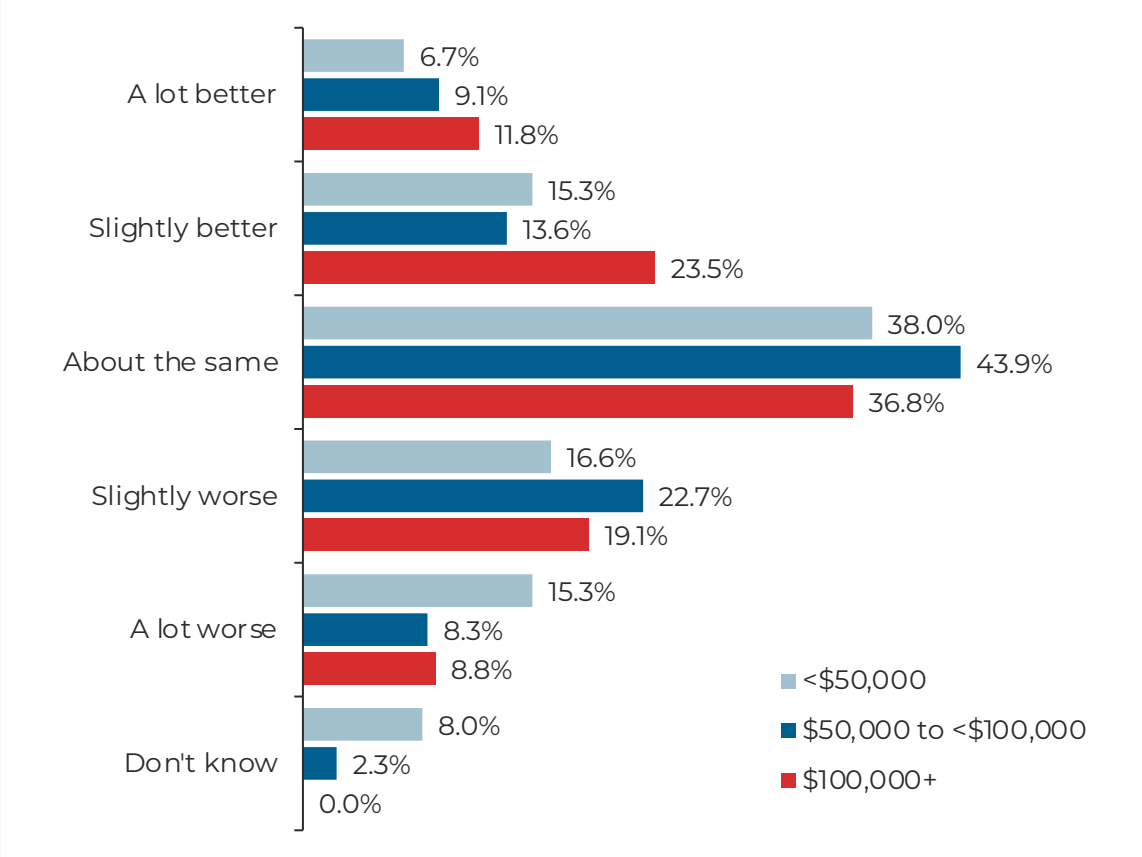
$100,000+ Net *better: 7.4%**

$50,000 to <$100,000 Net *worse*: 8.3%

<$50,000+ Net *worse*: 9.8%

**Net better = A lot and slightly better minus a lot and slightly worse*

Figure 13.
Respondents Who Celebrate the Holiday Season: How They Expect Their Financial Situation in the 2026 Holiday Season to Compare to Holiday 2025, by Household Income (% of Respondents)



Base: 369 surveyed on September 28, 2026 (about expectations for the 2026 holiday season)
Source: Coresight Research

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Consumers are evenly split between starting their holiday shopping early and delaying it until later

We asked consumers to choose the statement from each row that best represents their holiday shopping preference.

- This holiday season, consumers are almost evenly divided between starting holiday shopping **early (50.4%)** and leaving purchases until **later (49.6%)**. That split, alongside strong engagement with both October promotions and Black Friday, suggests a prolonged promotional window rather than one concentrated peak.
- **Half** of holiday shoppers prefer to spend on experiences rather than gifts—and **a similar proportion** prefer to spend on gifts.
- Slightly more holiday shoppers are interested in spending on experiences rather than gifts this holiday season than the proportion who are interested in spending on gifts.

Figure 14.
Holiday Shoppers: Holiday Shopping Preferences* (% of Respondents)

Start holiday shopping **early**	50.4%	←	49.6%	Leave shopping until relatively **late**
Interested in new and alternative options for gifting	50.9%	←	49.1%	**Not interested** in new and alternative options for gifting
Set a **budget** for gifts	46.9%	→	53.1%	Spend **what they need to** (within reason)
Prefer to buy holiday gifts **in-store**	52.6%	←	47.4%	Prefer to buy holiday gifts **online**
Like **spending time** on holiday gift shopping	52.0%	←	48.0%	Like getting holiday gift shopping done **efficiently**
Prefer to spend on **experiences** rather than gifts	50.7%	←	49.3%	Prefer to spend on **gifts** rather than experiences

**Respondents were asked to select one option that they most agree with for each pair of statements*
Base: 369 US respondents aged 18+ who celebrate the holiday season, surveyed on September 28, 2026 (about expectations for the 2026 holiday season)
Source: Coresight Research

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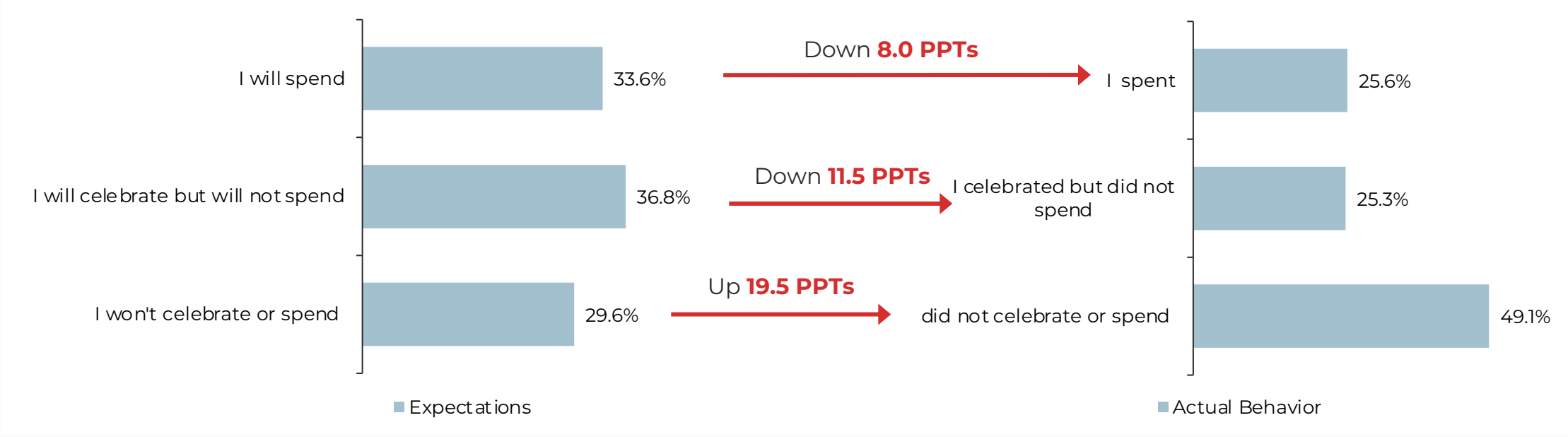
3Q26 Holidays: Recap

Labor Day

One-quarter of consumers spent on Labor Day this year

The proportion of consumers who actually spent on Labor Day was lower than the proportion who expected to do so: Consumers instead did not celebrate or spend.

Figure 15.
All Respondents: Whether They Expected To Celebrate or Spend on Labor Day This Year (Left) and Whether They Actually Did So (Right; % of Respondents)



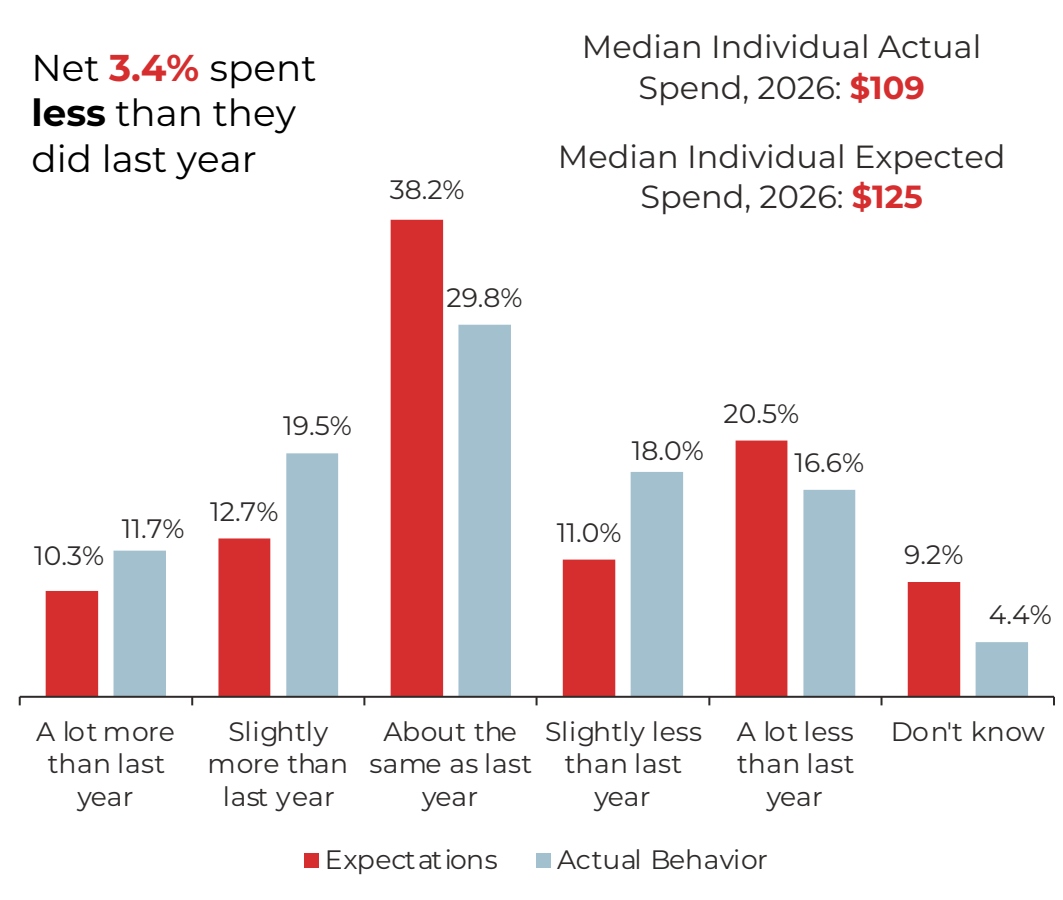
Base: Labor Day—402 US respondents aged 18+, surveyed in June 2026
Source: Coresight Research

Base: 403 US respondents aged 18+, surveyed in September 2026
Source: Coresight Research

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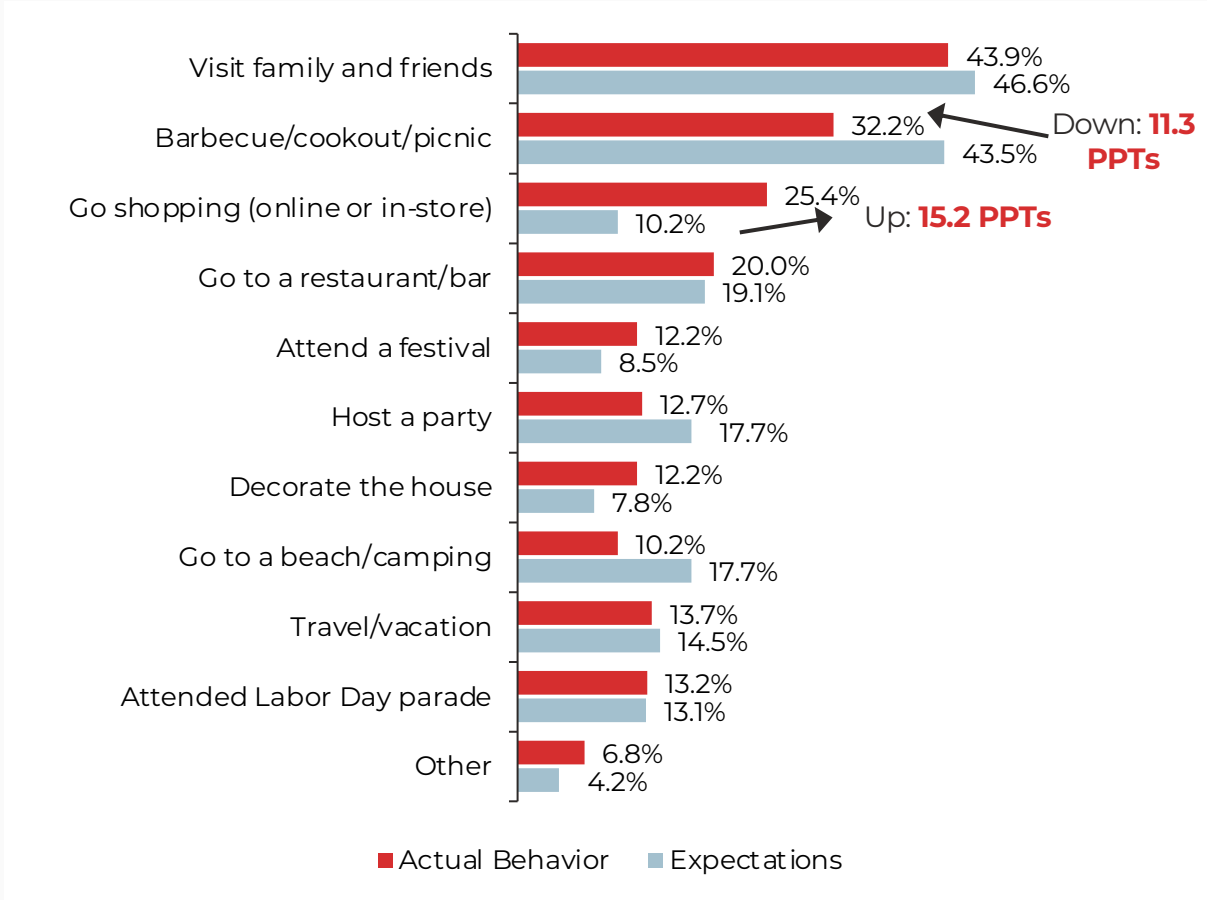
Labor Day: Weaker spending this year

Figure 16.
Respondents Who Expected To or Did Spend on Labor Day: How Much They Expected To and Did Spend Compared to Last Year (% of Respondents)



Base: US respondents aged 18+—283 who expected to spend on Labor Day, surveyed in June 2026; and 205 who spent on Labor Day, surveyed in September 2026
Source: Coresight Research

Figure 17.
Respondents Who Expected To or Did Celebrate or Spend on Labor Day: How They Expected To and Did Celebrate (% of Respondents)



Respondents could select multiple options
Base: US respondents aged 18+—283 who expected to celebrate and/or spend on Labor Day, surveyed in June 2026; and 205 who celebrated and/or spent on Labor Day, surveyed in September 2026
Source: Coresight Research

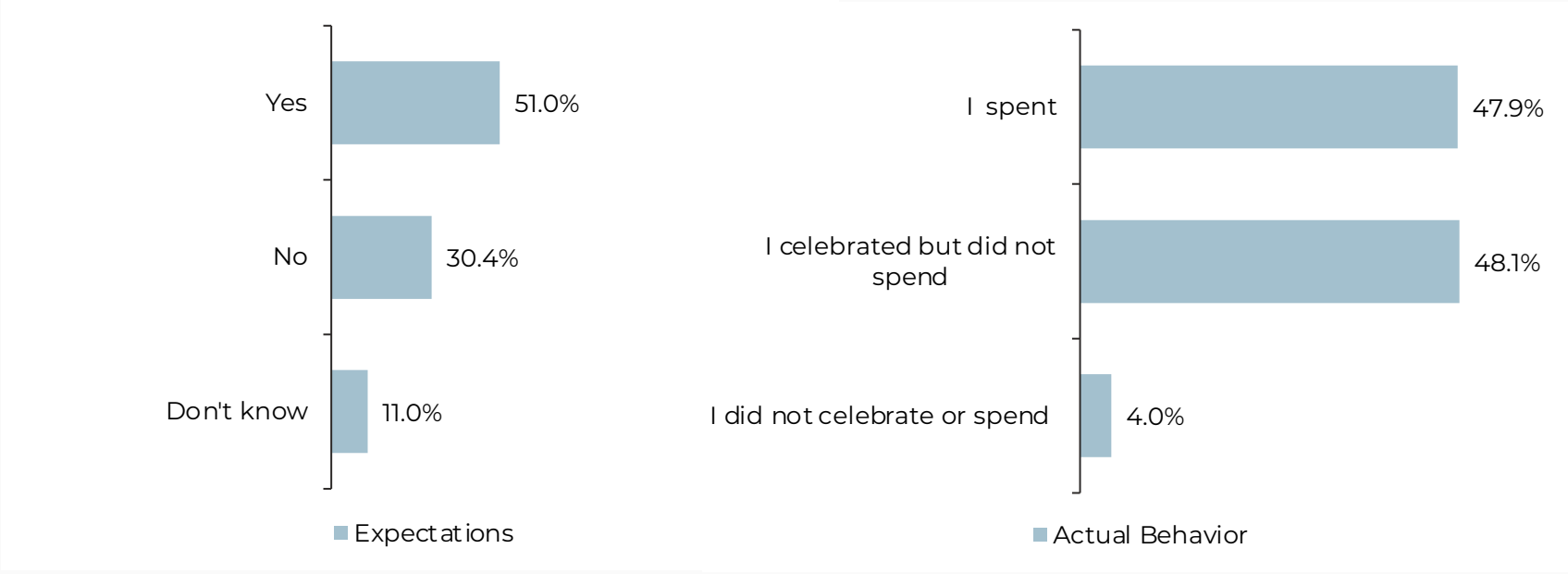
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The Fourth of July

Close to half of consumers celebrated or spent on the Fourth of July this year

The proportion of consumers who spent on the Fourth of July was slightly lower than the proportion who expected to celebrate or spend before the event. However, overall participation was stronger than expected, as many consumers celebrated without spending.

Figure 18.
All Respondents: Whether They Expected To Celebrate or Spend on the Fourth of July This Year (Left) and Whether They Actually Did So (Right; % of Respondents)

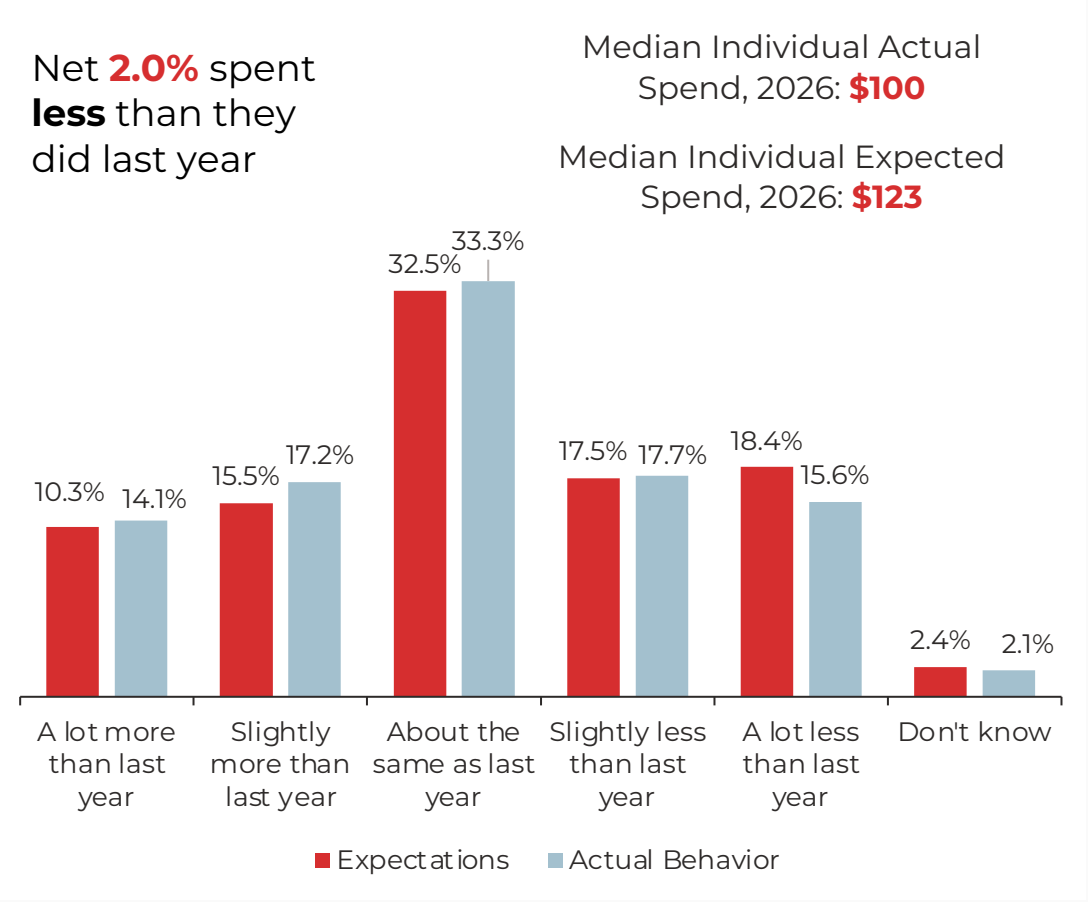


Base: 404 US respondents aged 18+, surveyed in May 2026
Source: Coresight Research

Base: 401 US respondents aged 18+, surveyed in July 2026
Source: Coresight Research

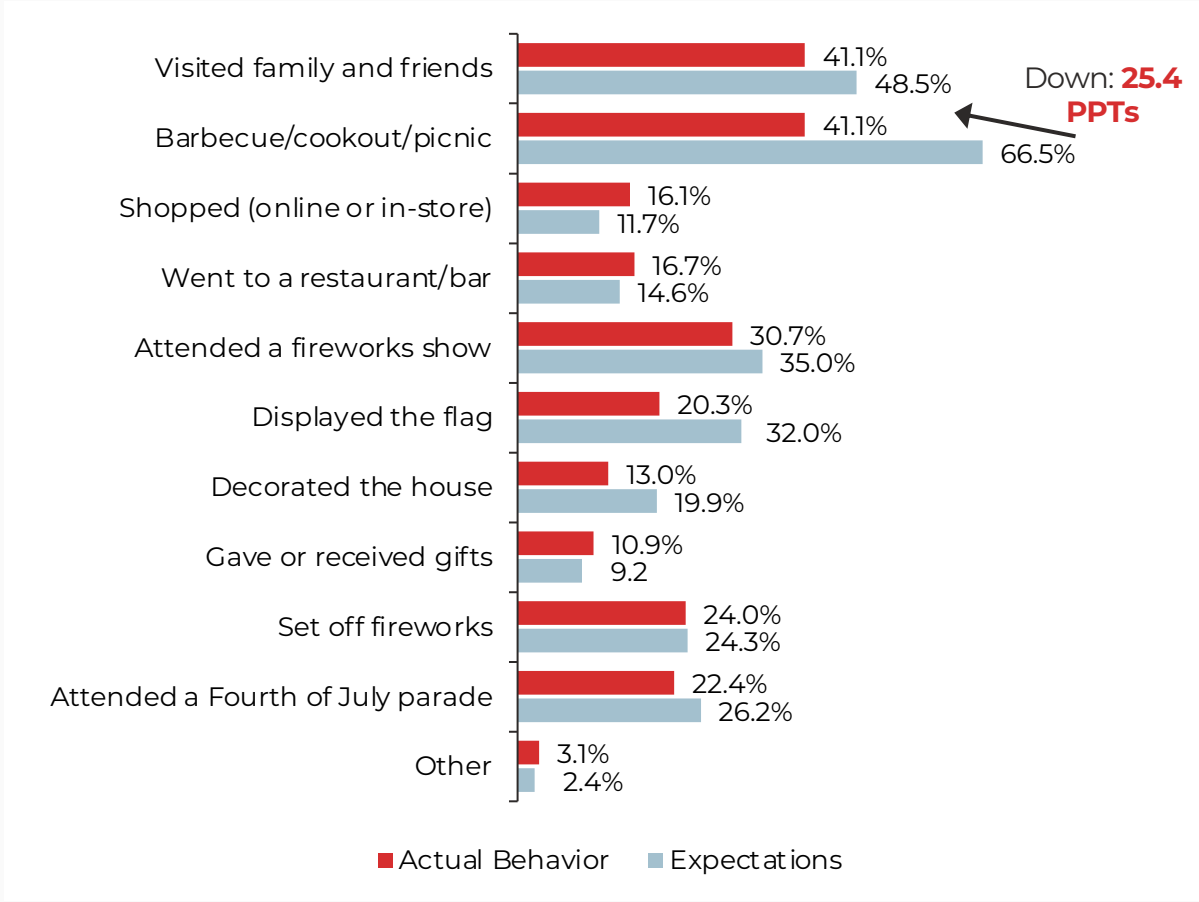
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Figure 19.
Respondents Who Expected To or Did Spend on the Fourth of July: How Much They Expected To and Did Spend Compared to Last Year (% of Respondents)



Base: US respondents aged 18+—206 who expected to spend on The Fourth of July, surveyed in May 2026; and 192 who spent on The Fourth of July, surveyed in July 2026
Source: Coresight Research

Figure 20.
Respondents Who Expected To or Did Celebrate or Spend on the Fourth of July: How They Expected To and Did Celebrate (% of Respondents)



Respondents could select multiple options
Base: US respondents aged 18+—206 who expected to spend on The Fourth of July, surveyed in May 2026; and 192 who spent on The Fourth of July, surveyed in July 2026
Source: Coresight Research

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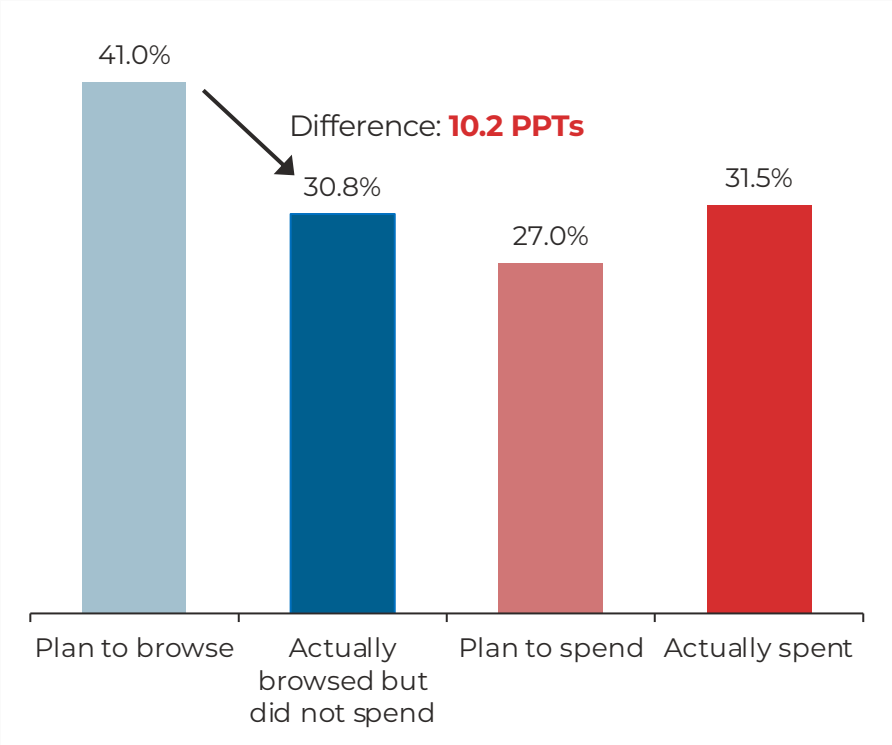
Amazon's Prime Day

Three in 10 consumers spent this year, and apparel/footwear and electronics categories proved most popular

The proportion of consumers who purchased Amazon's Prime Day promotions was slightly higher than expectations prior to the event, as shown in Figure 21.

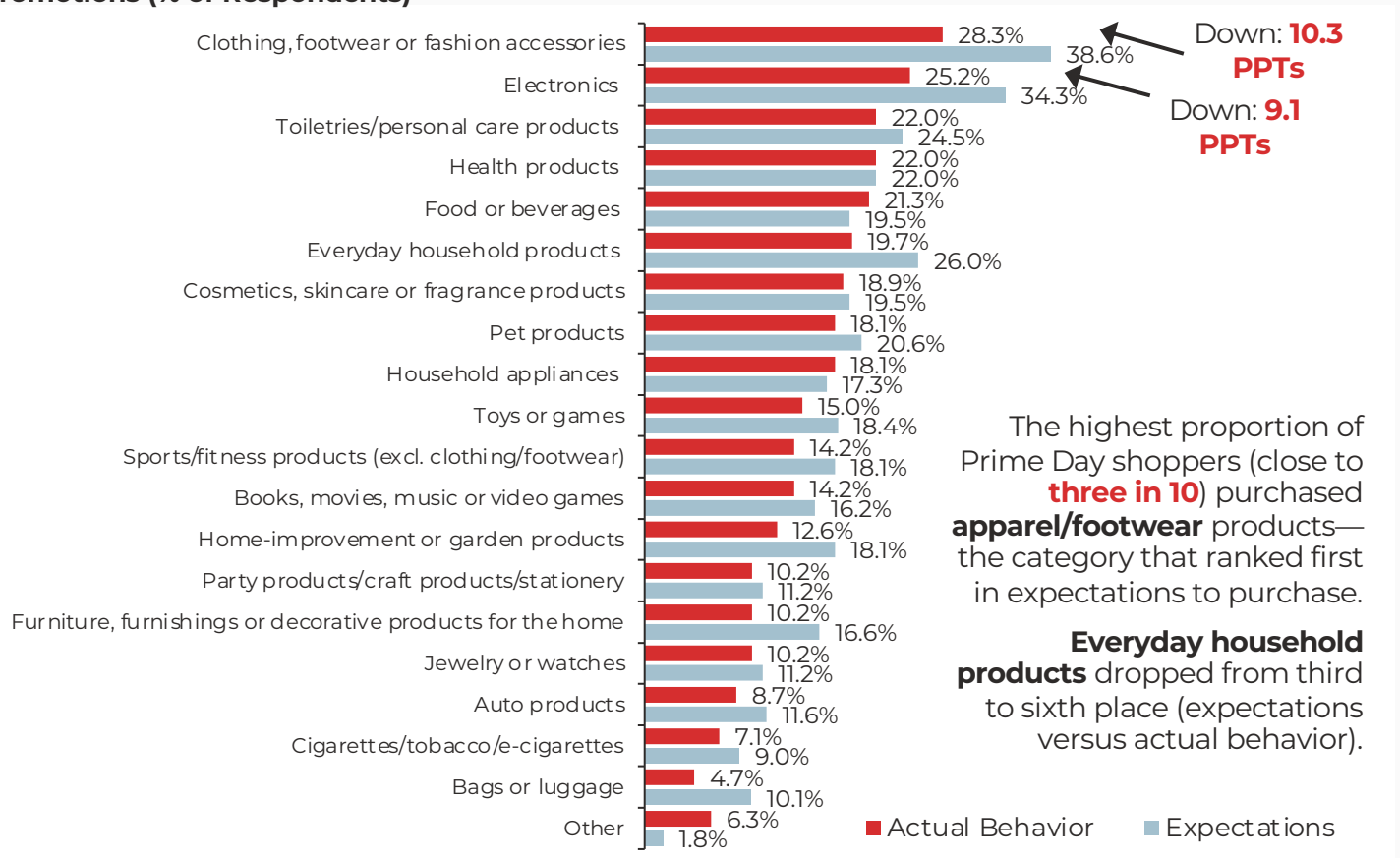
Spending versus Prime Day 2025 was down overall, our survey data suggested.

Figure 21.
All Respondents: Whether They Planned To and Did Shop Amazon's Prime Day Promotions (% of Respondents)



Base: US respondents aged 18+—404 surveyed in May 2026 and 403 surveyed in July 2026
Source: Coresight Research

Figure 22.
Prime Day Shoppers: Categories They Expected To and Did Purchase During Prime Day 2026 Promotions (% of Respondents)



The highest proportion of Prime Day shoppers (close to **three in 10**) purchased **apparel/footwear** products—the category that ranked first in expectations to purchase.

Everyday household products dropped from third to sixth place (expectations versus actual behavior).

Respondents could select multiple options
Base: US respondents aged 18+—277 who expected to browse or purchase Prime Day promotions on Amazon.com, surveyed in May 2026; and 127 who actually made a purchase, surveyed in July 2026
Source: Coresight Research

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What We Think

Implications from this Report

The 2026 holiday season is likely to be characterized by cautious optimism, increased deal discovery and uneven consumer spending patterns. While consumers appear willing to participate in key shopping moments, underlying financial concerns suggest that retailers will need to work harder to unlock discretionary spending. We expect holiday growth to be driven less by broad-based consumer confidence and more by targeted promotions, value-oriented shopping behavior and higher-income households' continued willingness to spend.

Holiday 2026 spending expectations remain positive, but momentum has softened, as highlighted in our main ***Holiday 2026: US Consumer Survey and Retail Outlook*** report (published October 5, 2026). Consumers are rethinking how they shop, with their financial situation and inflationary pressure becoming the leading factors influencing holiday budgets. Higher-income shoppers are likely to continue supporting discretionary purchases, while more budget-conscious consumers are expected to rely on promotions, value-oriented channels and trade-down strategies.

With consumers showing interest in shopping events more widely but remaining cautious about their financial outlook, discounts and perceived value will likely play a larger role in purchase decisions. Retailers may need to compete not only on price but also on convenience, loyalty benefits, personalized offers and bundled value propositions to convert browsing into purchases.

The continued preference for online and omnichannel shopping suggests that consumers will move fluidly between channels based on convenience, availability and price. Retailers with integrated online and physical experiences—including flexible fulfillment, easy returns and real-time inventory visibility—will be better positioned to capture demand across the extended holiday season.

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Methodology

Coresight Research surveys US consumers aged 18+ online each week. Informing the data in this report are surveys of US consumers online—on September 14 (401 respondents), September 7 (403 respondents), August 31 (401 respondents), August 24 (404 respondents), August 17 (402 respondents), August 10 (404 respondents), July 13 (403 respondents), July 6 (403 respondents), June 15 (402 respondents), June 1 (402 respondents), May 25 (404 respondents), May 4 (404 respondents), March 9 (400 respondents) and January 19 (400 respondents), 2026.

The weekly results have a maximum margin of error of +/- 4.9%, at a 95% confidence level. The four-week rolling average results have a maximum margin of error of +/- 2.4%, at a 95% confidence level. Visit our methodology page for more information, including on how actual margins of error may be lower than these maximums.

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